

Question 15 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Analyse the relationship among HRD philosophy, HRD climate, and organisational performance.

Introduction

These three form a chain. Philosophy is what leaders believe about people. Climate is what employees feel. Performance is what the organisation achieves. Analysis should show how one produces the next, and how they can also fail together.

Detailed points

1. HRD philosophy defined. Philosophy is the belief that people have potential, deserve development, and that developing them is a managerial duty — not a cost to cut when profits dip. It values human beings. Without philosophy, HRD tools are copied from other companies without conviction.

2. Philosophy shapes practices. If leaders truly believe the philosophy, appraisal becomes developmental, time is released for learning, and counselling is real. If philosophy is only in the annual report, practices remain punitive. Practices are philosophy made visible.

3. Practices create climate. Employees do not read philosophy booklets; they experience bosses. Consistent developmental practices produce perceptions of openness, trust and support — HRD climate. Inconsistent practices produce cynicism.

4. Climate shapes behaviour. Supportive climate → initiative, learning, collaboration, honest reporting of problems. Weak climate → fear, hiding, minimum work. Behaviour is the bridge to results.

5. Behaviour produces performance. Quality, productivity, innovation, customer satisfaction and adaptability improve when behaviour is enabling. Thus philosophy, through climate and behaviour, reaches organisational performance.

6. Reverse loops. Good performance can confirm philosophy ('investment in people paid off') and strengthen climate. Bad performance with impatient leadership can kill HRD budgets, worsening climate and causing a downward spiral.

7. Inconsistency as the analytical key. The dangerous case is high-sounding philosophy + weak climate. Employees hear 'people are our greatest asset' and see the opposite. Trust collapses more than if nothing was promised. Performance then suffers from cynicism.

8. Implication. To improve performance, do not start with a poster. Start with philosophy that leaders will live, then practices, then climate. Measuring only performance and ignoring climate misleads management.

Conclusion. Draw the chain: Philosophy → practices → HRD climate → employee behaviour → organisational performance, with feedback loops. Warn that slogans without climate destroy performance.